

Yu Qiu

Updated: September 2026

Placement director:	Dr. Andreas Ferrara	(412) 499-0819	a.ferrara@pitt.edu
Placement officer:	Mr. Dane Youkers	(412) 624-6094	dcy14@pitt.edu
Department of Economics		Email: YUQ23@pitt.edu	
University of Pittsburgh		Web: jessyuqiu.github.io	
4700 Wesley W. Posvar Hall		Phone: (412) 209-5610	
Pittsburgh, PA 15260			

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Economics, University of Pittsburgh, 2021-2027 (expected)
Committee: Andreas Ferrara (Co-chair), Daniel Berkowitz (Co-chair), Muhammad Yasir Khan, Osea Giuntella, and Vasiliki Fouka
M.A. Economics, University of Pittsburgh, 2023
B.A. Economics & B.S. Mathematics (*with distinction*), Wuhan University, 2021

RESEARCH FIELD

Labor Economics, Political Economy, Development Economics, Economic History

JOB MARKET PAPER

[“Fathers in Office, Sons in Jobs: Intergenerational Returns to Local Political Office”](#)

Abstract: Can local political office shape access to better jobs, and how do constraints on hiring discretion affect these advantages? I study these questions using newly digitized rosters of Ohio township, village, and city officials linked to full-count U.S. censuses, and tracing their *adult children* from 1900 to 1940. Using a matched difference-in-differences design, I find that fathers’ entry into office increases sons’ occupational income and white-collar employment, with gains persisting for decades. In 1940, officials’ sons earn about 13% more than their matched counterparts. Effects on daughters are more limited in this period of low female labor force participation. One important channel is better access to public employment, with larger effects where local officials have greater scope to influence hiring. Officeholding also increases sons’ private-sector white-collar employment, particularly in sectors where relationships with local government may be valuable. Among city officials, merit-based civil service reform does not eliminate these advantages; instead, private-sector white-collar gains become larger when fathers enter office under civil service. Finally, I find suggestive evidence that greater representation of officials’ sons in public employment is associated with higher local income inequality, particularly where public hiring discretion is greater and economic opportunities are limited.

WORKING PAPERS

1. [“Building Jobs: Employment Stabilization and Construction in China”](#)

2. “Migrant Integration and Social Stability: Evidence from China”, with Weizheng Lai
3. “Geopolitical Tensions and Economic Opportunity: Evidence from Japan”, with Weizheng Lai

PUBLICATION

1. “Are More Children Better than One? Evidence from a Lab Experiment of Decision Making”, with Xun Li, *China Economic Review*, Vol. 69, October 2021

WORK IN PROGRESS

1. “Bureaucratic Quality and Local Industrial Development”, with Muhammad Yasir Khan and S. K. Ritadhi
2. “Representation and Resource Allocation Before and After the 17th Amendment”, with Noah Braun, Paige Montrose, and Lauren Olson

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor, Intro Microeconomic Theory 2024, 2025
 Teaching Assistant, Health Economics 2024, 2026
 Teaching Assistant, Intro Microeconomic Theory 2023
 Teaching Assistant, Intro Development Economics 2022
 Teaching Assistant, Ph.D. Math Camp 2022

SEMINAR AND WORKSHOP PRESENTATION

2026: Applied Young Economists’ Webinar (AYEW), AMIE Workshop, BEDI Labor and Development Conference, Cliometrics Conference, EUI PEARL Workshop, EALE Conference, EHA Conference
 2025: Labor and Development Brownbag, Applied Microeconomics Brownbag (University of Pittsburgh)
 2024: SEA Meeting, UEA NA Meeting, 23rd CEPR Summer School in International and Development Economics, CES NA Annual Conference, Labor and Development Brownbag, Applied Microeconomics Brownbag (University of Pittsburgh)
 2023: Labor and Development Brownbag, Applied Microeconomics Brownbag (University of Pittsburgh)
 2020: The 12th International Symposium on Human Capital and Labor Markets

AWARDS AND GRANTS

PBC Travel Grants, University of Pittsburgh (2024, 2026)
 Mellon Fellowship, University of Pittsburgh (2024-2025)
 Best Second-year Paper Award (2024)

Chou Predoctoral Fellowship for Economics, University of Pittsburgh (2021-2022, 2025-2026)
Arts and Sciences Summer Fellowships, 2023
China National Scholarship (2020)
First Class Scholarship, Wuhan University (2019, 2020)

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES AND MEMBERSHIP

Journal referee for: *China Economic Review*, *The Journal of the Economics of Ageing*
Member of: Economic History Association, Cliometric Society, European Association of Labor Economists, American Economic Association
Graduate Student Peer Mentor, University of Pittsburgh, 2022-2024

SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

Software: Stata, Matlab, Python
Language: Mandarin Chinese, English, Spanish (basic)

REFERENCES

Prof. Andreas Ferrara
Department of Economics
University of Pittsburgh
a.ferrara@pitt.edu

Prof. Daniel Berkowitz
Department of Economics
University of Pittsburgh
dmberk@pitt.edu

Prof. Yasir Khan
Department of Economics
University of Pittsburgh
myk17@pitt.edu

Prof. Osea Giuntella
Department of Economics
University of Pittsburgh
osea.giuntella@pitt.edu